

BRIDGEWORK - STARTUPX PILOT BUILDATHON 2026

STUDENT PARTICIPATION, CONFIDENTIALITY, MEMBERSHIP, NON-CIRCUMVENTION & PLACEMENT AGREEMENT

THIS AGREEMENT is entered into on the date of signature by the Parties identified below.

1. PARTIES

This Student Participation, Confidentiality, Membership, Non-Circumvention and Placement Agreement ("**Agreement**") is entered into between:

BridgeWork

BridgeWork (Pty) Ltd (or BridgeWork pending formal registration)

(hereinafter referred to as "**BridgeWork**") and

Participant

Full Name: _____ Noluthando Buda _____

Student Number: _____ 2028419741 _____

University: _____ University of the Free State _____

ID / Passport Number: _____ 0703091222082 _____

Email Address: _____ 2028419741@ufs4life.ac.za _____

Telephone Number: _____ 0762664887 _____

Date: _____ 24/07/2026 _____

BridgeWork and the Participant are collectively referred to as the "**Parties**" and individually as a "**Party**".

2. PURPOSE OF THIS AGREEMENT

The purpose of this Agreement is to establish the rights, responsibilities, obligations and expectations applicable to the Participant's involvement in the **StartupX Pilot Buildathon 2026**.

This Agreement is intended to:

- protect the legitimate interests of BridgeWork;
- protect the commercial interests and confidential information of participating businesses;
- promote ethical and professional conduct;
- establish a framework for future collaboration and talent placement; and
- foster a sustainable ecosystem that benefits students, businesses and BridgeWork.

3. PARTICIPATION

The Participant agrees to:

3.1 participate actively and professionally throughout the StartupX programme;

3.2 complete assigned tasks to the best of their ability;

3.3 meet all agreed milestones and submission deadlines;

3.4 conduct themselves respectfully towards fellow participants, participating businesses, mentors and organisers;

3.5 comply with all programme rules, guidelines and reasonable instructions issued by BridgeWork; and

3.6 represent BridgeWork professionally, both online and offline, throughout the duration of the programme.

4. CONFIDENTIALITY

4.1 Confidential Information

During participation in StartupX, the Participant may receive access to confidential or proprietary information, including but not limited to:

- business concepts;
- business models;
- strategic plans;
- logos and branding;
- marketing materials;
- photographs and media;
- customer information;
- supplier information;
- technical documentation;
- software-related information;
- financial information;
- website content;
- internal documentation; and
- any other information identified as confidential.

4.2 Confidentiality Obligations

The Participant undertakes that they shall not, without prior written consent:

- a. disclose Confidential Information to any third party;
- b. reproduce, copy or distribute Confidential Information;
- c. use Confidential Information for any purpose unrelated to StartupX;
- d. claim ownership of any Confidential Information; or
- e. use Confidential Information for personal or commercial gain.

4.3 Survival

The obligations contained in this clause shall survive the completion or termination of the Participant's involvement in StartupX.

5. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The Participant acknowledges and agrees that:

5.1 all pre-existing intellectual property remains the sole property of the participating business;

5.2 all trademarks, trade names, logos, branding, business content and proprietary materials remain the exclusive property of the respective business owner;

5.3 the Participant retains ownership of their personal skills, experience, programming knowledge and general methodologies developed independently; and

5.4 unless otherwise agreed in writing, any website, software solution or digital product specifically developed for the participating business under StartupX may be transferred to that business upon completion of the programme.

6. PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

The Participant undertakes to:

- a. conduct themselves with honesty, integrity and professionalism;
- b. communicate respectfully with businesses, mentors, organisers and fellow participants;
- c. work collaboratively within their assigned team;
- d. resolve disagreements professionally and constructively;
- e. protect the reputation and goodwill of BridgeWork; and
- f. comply with all applicable laws and university policies.

BridgeWork reserves the right to suspend or remove any Participant whose conduct is deemed detrimental to the programme or its stakeholders.

7. NON-CIRCUMVENTION

The Participant acknowledges that BridgeWork has invested time, resources and commercial effort in establishing relationships between participating businesses and student developers.

Accordingly, for a period of **twelve (12) months** following completion of StartupX, the Participant agrees that they shall not:

- a. knowingly accept paid work directly from a participating business introduced through BridgeWork without first notifying BridgeWork;

- b. enter into freelance, consulting or commercial arrangements arising directly from the StartupX introduction without BridgeWork's knowledge;
- c. intentionally circumvent BridgeWork in relation to opportunities created through the StartupX programme.

Where a participating business wishes to continue engaging the Participant, BridgeWork shall be notified so that the engagement may be facilitated transparently.

Nothing contained in this clause shall prohibit the Participant from accepting employment or opportunities obtained independently and unrelated to BridgeWork introductions.

8. PLACEMENT & TALENT AGREEMENT

The Participant acknowledges that BridgeWork exists to connect talented students with meaningful industry opportunities.

Should the Participant receive an offer for:

- freelance work;
- contract work;
- internship opportunities;
- permanent employment;
- website maintenance;
- software development;
- digital consulting; or
- future technology projects, from a business introduced through BridgeWork,

the Participant agrees to:

- a. notify BridgeWork before accepting such opportunity;
- b. permit BridgeWork to facilitate the engagement where appropriate;
- c. act transparently and in good faith throughout the process; and
- d. maintain professional communication with both BridgeWork and the participating business.

BridgeWork may coordinate future placements to ensure the sustainability of its talent ecosystem and the continued benefit of students and participating businesses.

9. BRIDGEWORK STUDENT MEMBERSHIP

Participation in StartupX automatically grants the Participant **BridgeWork Student Membership** at no additional cost.

As a **Founding Student Member**, the Participant shall receive:

- priority access to BridgeWork projects before public release;
- priority consideration for internships, freelance work and placements;
- early access to the BridgeWork platform upon launch;
- invitations to workshops, networking events, innovation programmes and hackathons;
 - early communication regarding partnerships and opportunities; and
 - membership of the BridgeWork student community.

BridgeWork intends to prioritise opportunities for registered members before making such opportunities publicly available.

Student Membership does not constitute a guarantee of employment or remuneration.

10. FOUNDING STARTUPX COHORT

The Participant shall be permanently recognised as a member of the **Founding StartupX Cohort 2026**.

BridgeWork may recognise founding members in connection with:

- future StartupX programmes;
- publications;
- events;
- promotional campaigns;
- marketing material;
- alumni initiatives; and
- community recognition programmes.

11. PORTFOLIO RIGHTS

The Participant may include completed StartupX work within their professional portfolio provided that:

- a. confidential information is not disclosed;
- b. the participating business has publicly released the website or granted permission; and
- c. any reference to the project accurately reflects the Participant's contribution.

12. NO GUARANTEE OF EMPLOYMENT

Participation in StartupX shall not constitute or imply any guarantee of:

- employment;
- internship;
- freelance work;
- paid engagement; or ☐ future contracts.

BridgeWork shall, however, endeavour to facilitate future opportunities for registered members where reasonably possible.

13. LIMITATION OF LIABILITY

BridgeWork acts solely as the facilitator of StartupX.

Accordingly, BridgeWork shall not be liable for:

- a. disputes arising between Participants and participating businesses;
- b. business decisions made after completion of StartupX;
- c. losses arising from work undertaken outside the agreed programme scope;
- d. commercial agreements entered into independently by Participants or businesses; or
- e. indirect or consequential damages arising from participation in StartupX.

14. BREACH OF AGREEMENT

Where the Participant intentionally breaches this Agreement, BridgeWork reserves the right to:

- a. remove the Participant from StartupX;
- b. suspend or terminate BridgeWork Student Membership;
- c. restrict participation in future BridgeWork programmes;
- d. decline future project allocations; and
- e. pursue any legal remedies available under applicable law where appropriate.

BridgeWork shall endeavour to resolve disputes amicably before instituting formal proceedings.

15. GENERAL PROVISIONS

15.1 Entire Agreement

This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the Parties relating to the Participant's involvement in StartupX.

15.2 Amendments

No amendment to this Agreement shall be valid unless reduced to writing and signed by both Parties.

15.3 Severability

Should any provision of this Agreement be found invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect.

15.4 Governing Law

This Agreement shall be governed by and interpreted in accordance with the laws of the **Republic of South Africa**.

16. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By signing below, the Participant confirms that they:

- have read and understood this Agreement in its entirety;
- have had the opportunity to seek independent advice if desired;

- understand the rights and obligations contained herein;
- voluntarily agree to be bound by its terms; and
- acknowledge their responsibilities as a BridgeWork Student Member and StartupX Participant.

SIGNATURES

Participant

Full Name: Noluthando Buda

Signature: 

Date: 24/07/2026

For and on behalf of BridgeWork

Representative Name: _____

Position: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

BridgeWork

"We don't simulate experience, we create it."